

GitHub:

Site:

License: No external font files are bundled or redistributed with this project; the typefaces are supplied by the operating system or browser environment.

AI Disclosure:

Editorial Feature

Pinned in Place

Why Community Boards Still Matter

Community bulletin boards are easy to ignore. They sit near the entrance of a coffee shop, apartment building, library, school, or community center, usually covered in flyers that have been pinned, stapled, layered, and forgotten. Some are neat and organized. Others look like they have been collecting paper since 2004.

Either way, people still use them.

That feels a little strange when so much of our communication has moved online. If someone wants to advertise an event, sell a couch, find a roommate, or offer a service, they can post it online in a few seconds. A paper flyer pinned to a wall obviously cannot compete with the reach of the internet.

But reach is not the only thing that matters.

A bulletin board puts information directly into a place people are already using. You don't have to follow the right account or know what to search for. Sometimes you are waiting for coffee, walking into class, checking your mail, or leaving a building when something catches your eye.

You weren't looking for it. You just happened to see it.

A Snapshot of the People Around It

The thing I like about community boards is that they are rarely polished. They are usually a mix of whatever the people around them decided was worth sharing.

There might be a lost-pet flyer next to an advertisement for guitar lessons. Someone is selling a desk. Someone else is promoting a local event. There could be a volunteer opportunity, a club meeting, a room for rent, or a handwritten note with tear-off phone numbers along the bottom.

None of it necessarily belongs together. That is kind of the point.

Taken together, those notices can tell you something about the people who use that space. A college bulletin board will probably look different from one inside an apartment complex. A coffee shop board may look completely different from one at a community center.

Researchers Karen Fisher, Carol Landry, and Charles Naumer use the term “information grounds” to describe social settings where people exchange everyday information while they are primarily there for some other reason. In a 2007 study, the researchers examined these interactions among college students in public spaces on and around a university campus. Their research suggests that ordinary social spaces can play a meaningful role in how information moves between people.

A community bulletin board works in a similar way. The information is sitting directly in the path of people who are already there.

PULL QUOTE: A community bulletin board is basically a neighborhood conversation happening on paper.

Finding Something You Were Not Looking For

Online information is incredibly convenient, but it often depends on knowing where to look. You might need to join the right group, follow the right account, open a specific email, or type the right words into a search bar.

A physical bulletin board asks much less of you.

You can walk past it and notice something by accident.

That kind of accidental discovery is part of what makes physical community spaces interesting. In earlier research on information grounds, Fisher and her colleagues described these spaces as environments that can encourage spontaneous and unexpected information sharing when people come together for another purpose.

The bulletin board itself is obviously not creating those relationships. It is just one small part of the environment. But it gives people a place to leave information behind for whoever happens to come next.

The Design Actually Matters

There is also a design problem happening on every bulletin board.

When twenty pieces of paper are competing for attention, nobody is going to carefully study all twenty. A flyer has to make sense quickly.

A clear heading, readable text, enough contrast, and useful spacing can make a difference. These ideas are also reflected in guidance from the World Wide Web Consortium's Web Accessibility Initiative, which recommends sufficient contrast between text and its background and encourages the use of headings and spacing to group related information and make content easier to scan and understand.

The W3C guidance is meant for digital content, but the basic communication principle translates pretty easily to a printed flyer: people need to be able to find and understand the information in front of them.

If the date is tiny, the heading is difficult to find, or the text is crammed into every available inch of the page, the information may technically be there without being particularly useful.

Placement matters for the same reason. A great flyer doesn't help much if it is buried underneath five newer ones.

That makes each notice its own tiny communication problem: What is this? Who is it for? When is it happening? What does someone need to do next?

Still Useful, Just Differently

Community bulletin boards are not going to replace social media, email, or websites. They don't need to.

Their usefulness is much smaller and much more local.

Someone puts up a flyer because they want another person in that space to see it. Maybe somebody takes a picture of it. Maybe they tear off a phone number. Maybe they find out about something they never would have searched for on their own.

And printed community notices haven't disappeared. Tempe Public Library, for example, still maintains a formal policy governing printed materials that may be posted, displayed, or distributed inside the library. The policy allows certain government and approved nonprofit materials while restricting political, religious, commercial, and other for-profit advertising.

That doesn't mean bulletin boards are better than digital communication. It just means they still have a purpose alongside it.

They are simple, physical, and easy to overlook.

But sometimes that is exactly why they work.

Support and Fallback Record

Code	Purpose	Support	Fallback
position: absolute position: relative	Anchors the Community Feature badge to the feature header at larger widths	position CSS property - CSS MDN NOTE: This contains everything for absolute, relative, and sticky.	Badge returns to normal flow at smaller widths

position: sticky	Keeps the story guide available while reading at desktop widths	Checked On: 9/20/2026	Story guide remains in normal flow at smaller widths
z-index	Controls the pull-quote and sticky-navigation layers using tokens	z-index CSS property - CSS MDN Checked On: 9/20/2026	Normal source order remains readable
border-radius	Softens the feature figure container	border-radius CSS property - CSS MDN Checked On: 9/20/2026	Figure remains usable with square corners
clip-path	Adds the clipped corner to the feature image	clip-path CSS property - CSS MDN Checked On: 9/20/2026	Full rectangular photograph remains visible
shape-outside	Wraps text around the circular supporting image	shape-outside CSS property - CSS MDN Checked On: 9/20/2026	Image and text remain readable without shaped wrapping
shape-margin	Adds spacing around the shaped image	shape-margin CSS property - CSS MDN Checked On: 9/20/2026	Normal image margins provide spacing
aspect-ratio	Keeps the supporting image square before circular cropping	aspect-ratio CSS property - CSS MDN Checked On: 9/20/2026	Image retains usable intrinsic dimensions
object-fit	Crops the supporting image without stretching it	object-fit CSS property - CSS MDN	Image remains visible without the controlled crop

		Checked On: 9/20/2026	
@supports	Limits shape enhancements to browsers that understand them	@supports CSS at-rule - CSS MDN Checked On: 9/20/2026	Baseline rectangular/normal-flow presentation remains

Test Record

Test	Evidence
HTML Check - index.html - PASSED	Nu Html Checker This tool is an ongoing experiment in better HTML checking, and its behavior remains subject to change Showing results for uploaded file index.html (checked with vnu 26.9.16) Checker Input Show ☐ source ☐ outline ☐ image report ☐ errors & warnings only Options... Check by file upload Choose File No file chosen Uploaded files with .xhtml or .xht extensions are parsed using the XML parser. Check Document checking completed. No errors or warnings to show. Used the HTML parser. Total execution time 7 milliseconds.

HTML Check - composition-plan.html - **PASSED**

Nu Html Checker

This tool is an ongoing experiment in better HTML checking, and its behavior remains subject to change
Showing results for uploaded file composition-plan.html (checked with vnu 26.9.16)

Checker Input

Show ☐ source ☐ outline ☐ image report ☐ errors & warnings only

Check by No file chosen

Uploaded files with .xhtml or .xht extensions are parsed using the XML parser.

Document checking completed. No errors or warnings to show.

Used the HTML parser.
Total execution time 2 milliseconds.

CSS Check - **PASSED**

NOTE: The W3C CSS Validator reported three errors for the required shape-outside and shape-margin properties because they are not recognized by the selected CSS Level 3 + SVG profile. Two additional warnings noted that CSS custom properties cannot be statically checked. The required CSS Shapes declarations were retained, and no unrelated CSS syntax errors were reported.

W3C CSS Validator results for styles.css (CSS level 3 + SVG)

Sorry! We found the following errors (3)

URI : styles.css			
176		Property <code>shape-outside</code> doesn't exist	<code>circle(50%)</code>
179	<code>.shape-portrait</code>	Property <code>shape-outside</code> doesn't exist	<code>circle(50%)</code>
180	<code>.shape-portrait</code>	Property <code>shape-margin</code> doesn't exist	<code>var(--space-3)</code>



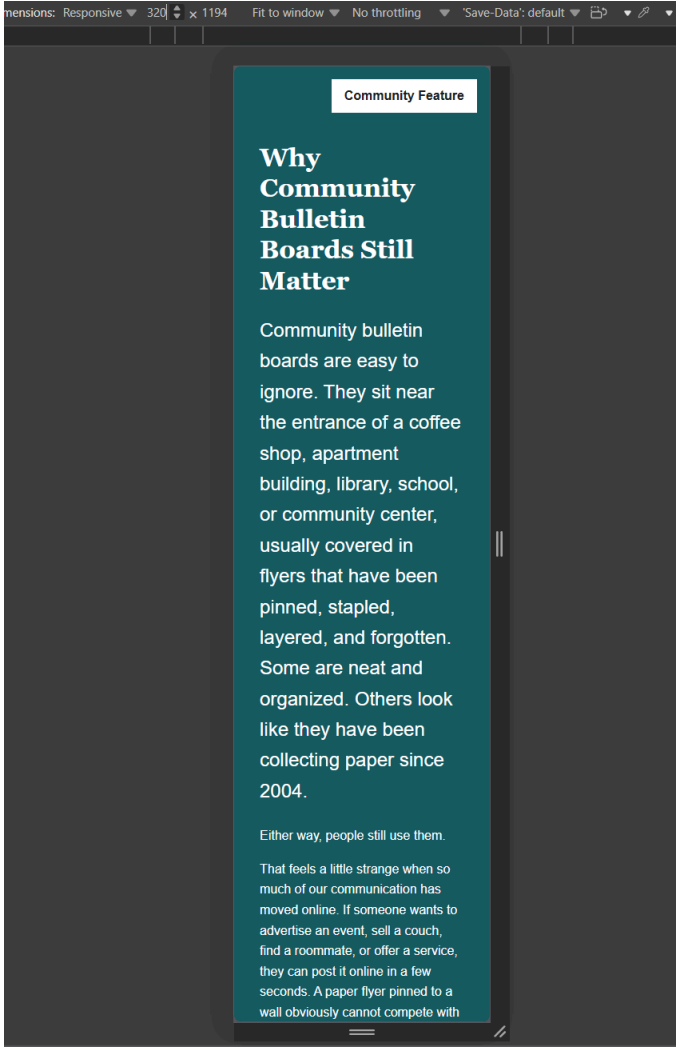
Interest

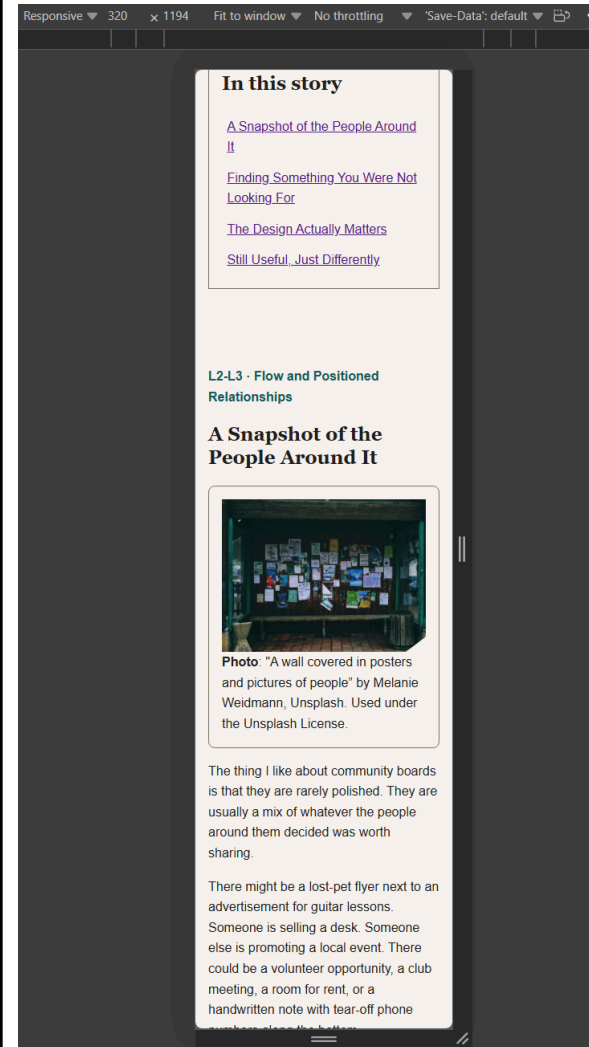
Warnings (2)

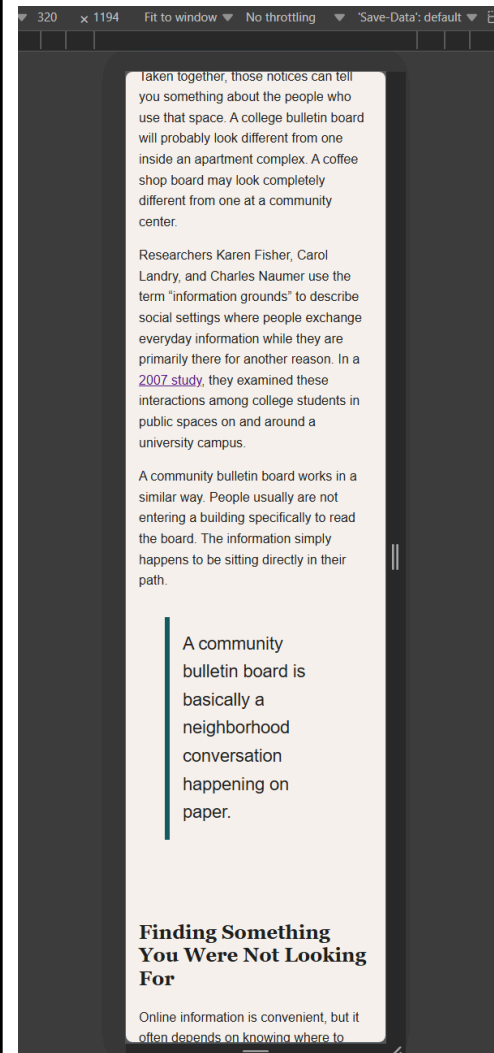
URI : styles.css		
54		Due to their dynamic nature, CSS variables are currently not statically checked
62		Due to their dynamic nature, CSS variables are currently not statically checked

Valid CSS information

320px - PASSED







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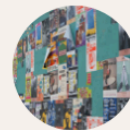
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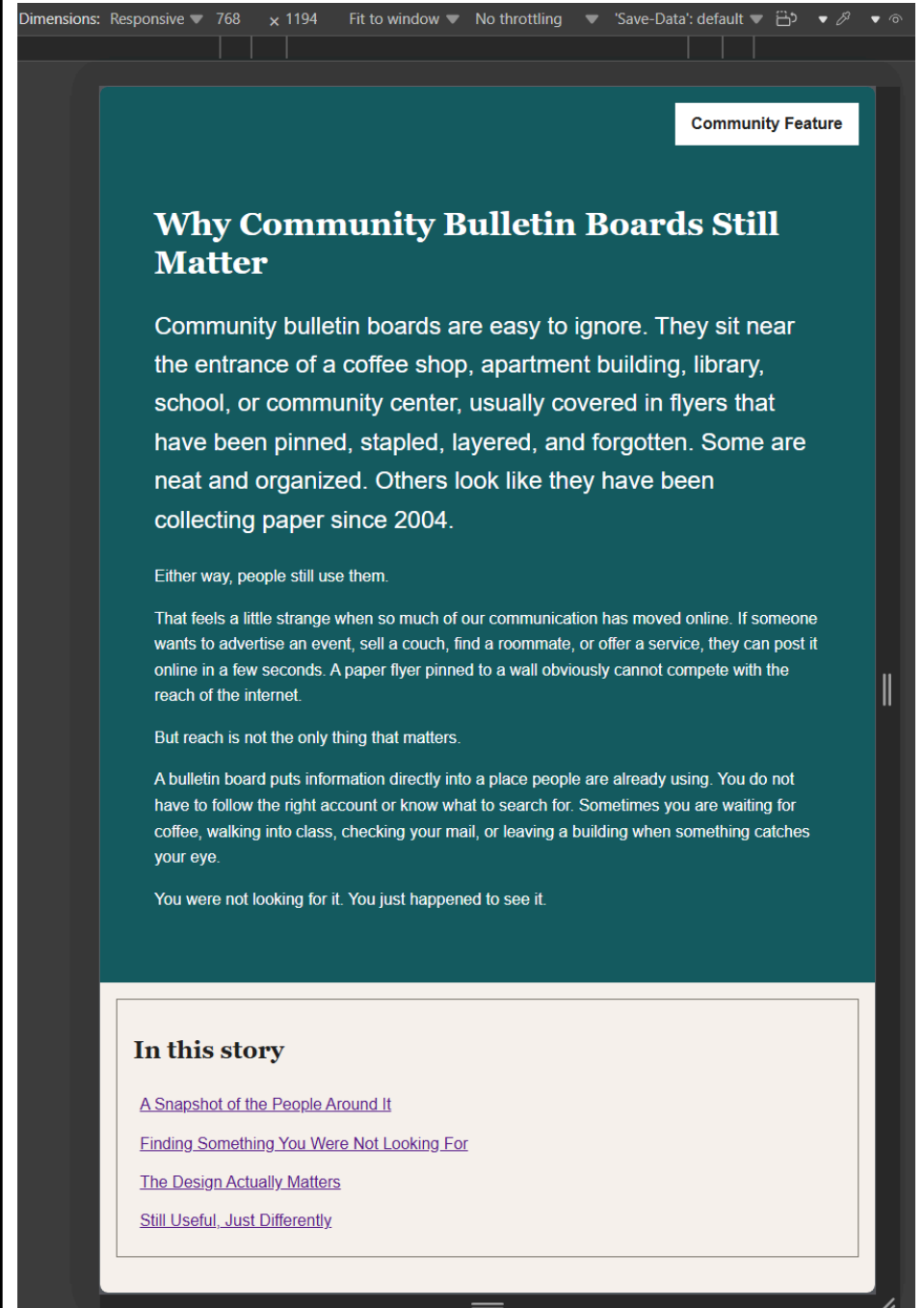
L4-L5 · Layers, Shapes, and Fallback

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768px - **PASSED**



L2-L3 · Flow and Positioned Relationships

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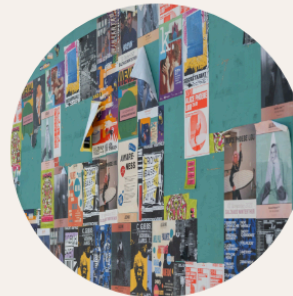
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L6 • Documentation and Testing

- [Composition plan](#)
- [Support and fallback record](#)
- [Test record](#)
- [Credits and attribution](#)
- [AI disclosure](#)

1280px - **PASSED**

Dimensions: Responsive ▼ 1280 x 1194 Fit to window ▼ No throttling ▼ 'Save Data': default ▼

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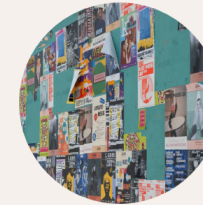
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L4-L6 · Layers, Shapes, and Fallback

The Design Actually Matters



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L6 · Documentation and Testing

Link the completed composition plan, support/fallback record, tests, credits, and disclosure.

200% Zoom - PASSED

Community Feature

Why Community Bulletin Boards Still Matter

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A Snapshot of the People Around It



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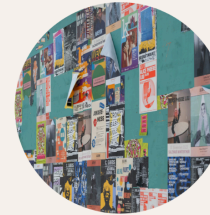
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L4-L5 · Layers, Shapes, and Fallback

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L6 • Documentation and Testing

- [Composition plan](#)
- [Master Record](#), [Support and Fallback](#), [Test Record](#), [Assets and Credits](#), [AI Disclosures](#), etc.

CSS-disabled - **PASS**

With CSS disabled, content remained complete and readable in logical order.

L.1 · Feature Story

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Community Feature

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L.2-L.3 · Flow and Positioned Relationships

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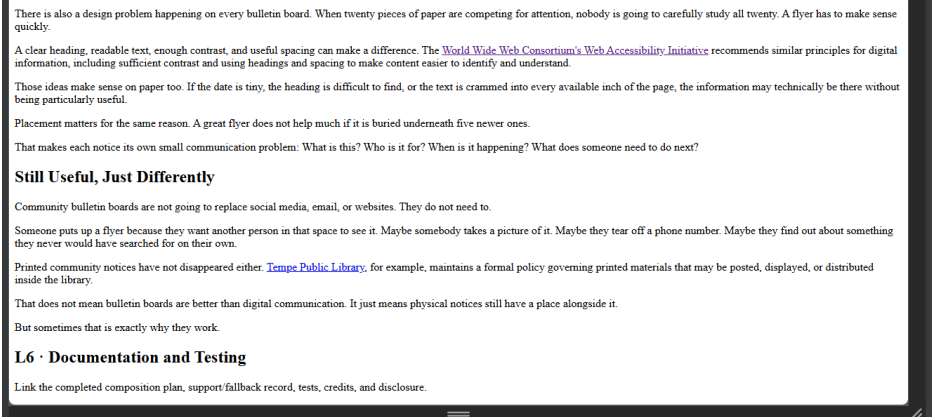
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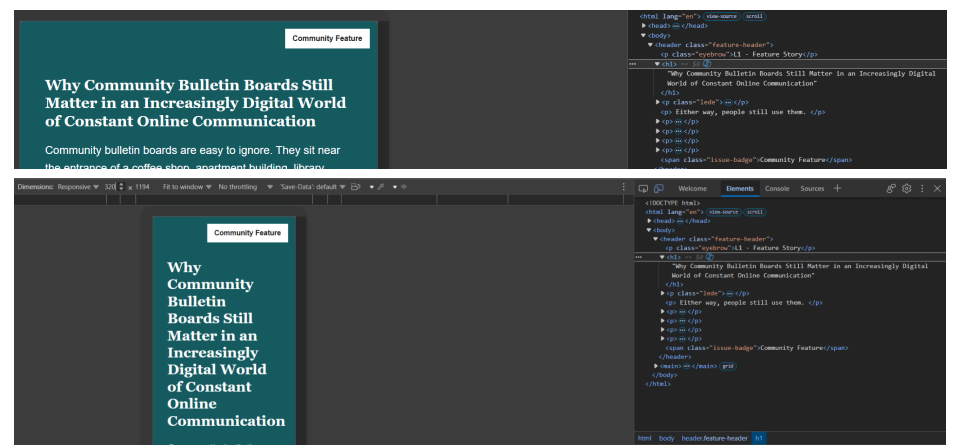
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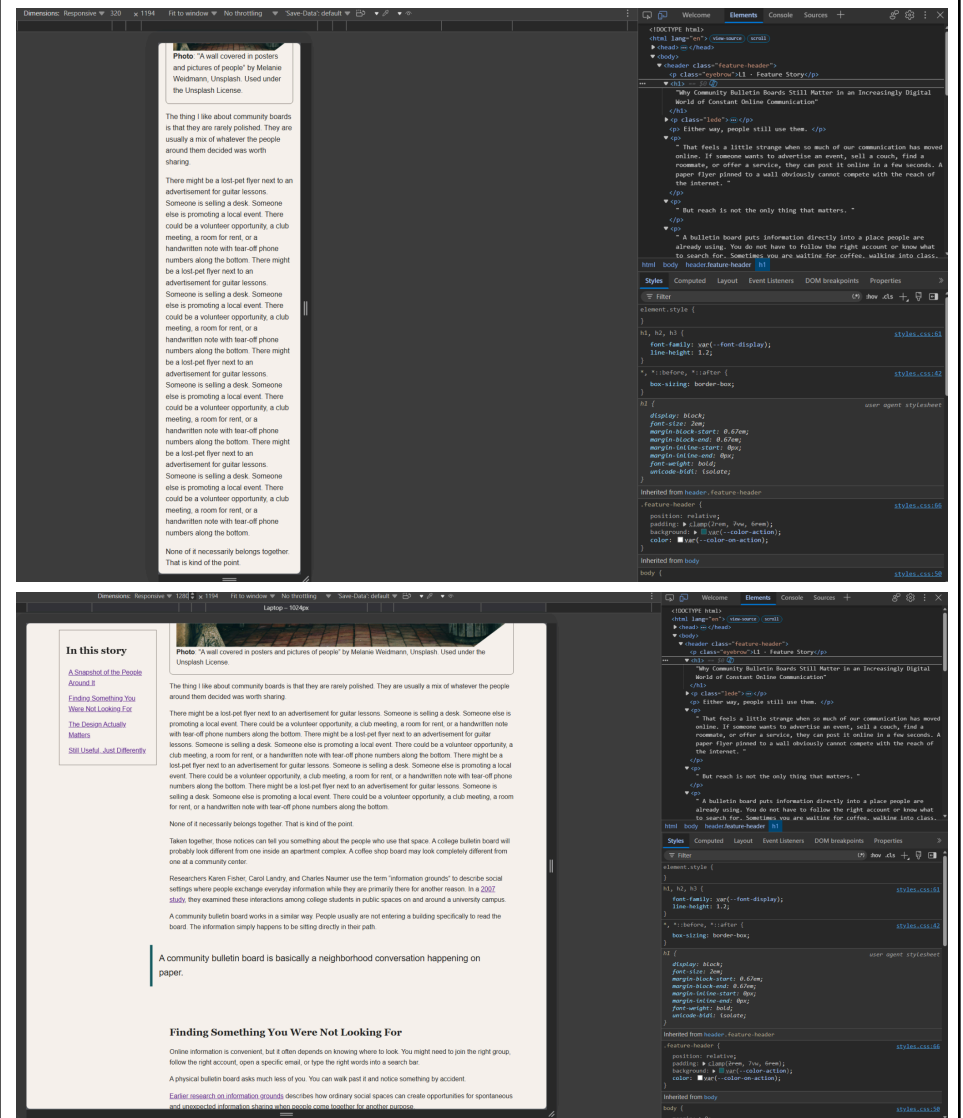


At both 1280px and 320px, the extended heading wrapped naturally without overlapping the positioned Community Feature badge or causing horizontal overflow. No responsive disengagement was necessary.



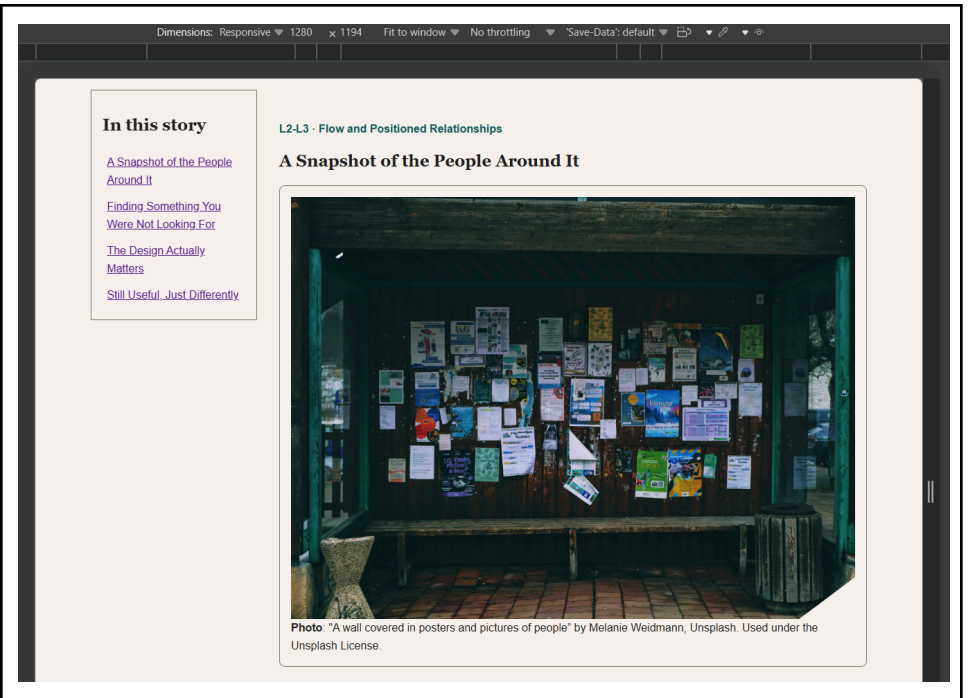
Doubled-paragraph growth - PASS

A story paragraph was duplicated at both 320px and 1280px. The section expanded vertically to accommodate the additional content without clipping, horizontal overflow, or unintended overlap. The surrounding Grid layout and positioned elements remained readable.



Sticky Behavior/Pointer Activation - **PASS**

Sticky navigation remained bounded by the story layout. All links remained pointer-accessible and no layered element intercepted interaction.



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A clear heading, readable text, enough contrast, and useful spacing can make a difference. The [World Wide Web Consortium's Web Accessibility Initiative](#) recommends similar principles for digital information, including sufficient contrast and using headings and spacing to make content easier to identify and understand.

Those ideas make sense on paper too. If the date is tiny, the heading is difficult to find, or the text is crammed into every available inch of the page, the information may technically be there without being particularly useful.

Placement matters for the same reason. A great flyer does not help much if it is buried underneath five newer ones.

That makes each notice its own small communication problem: What is this? Who is it for? When is it happening? What does someone need to do next?

Still Useful, Just Differently

Community bulletin boards are not going to replace social media, email, or websites. They do not need to.

Someone puts up a flyer because they want another person in that space to see it. Maybe somebody takes a picture of it. Maybe they tear off a phone number. Maybe they find out about something they never would have searched for on their own.

Printed community notices have not disappeared either. [Tempe Public Library](#), for example, maintains a formal policy governing printed materials that may be posted, displayed, or distributed inside the library.

That does not mean bulletin boards are better than digital communication. It just means physical notices still have a place alongside it.

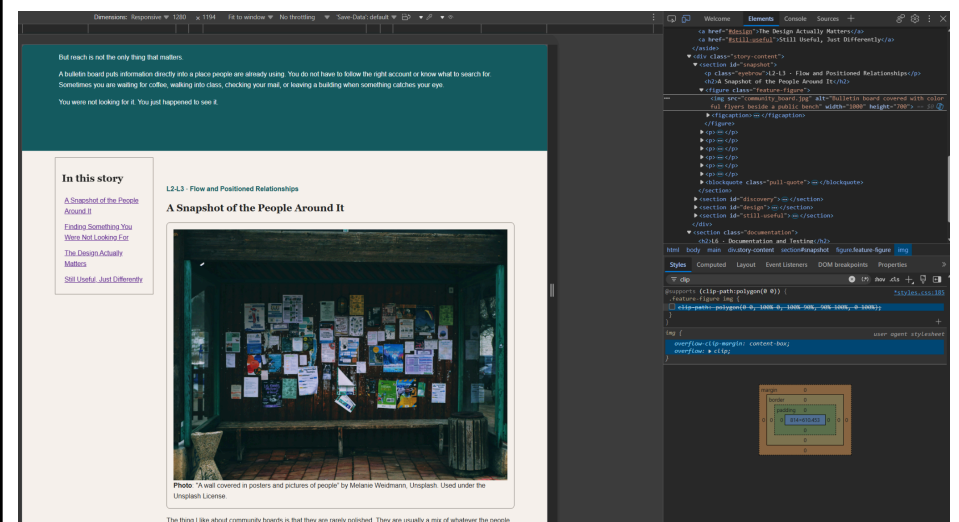
But sometimes that is exactly why they work.

L6 • Documentation and Testing

- [Composition plan](#)
- [Master Record, Support and Fallback, Test Record, Assets and Credits, AI Disclosures, etc.](#)

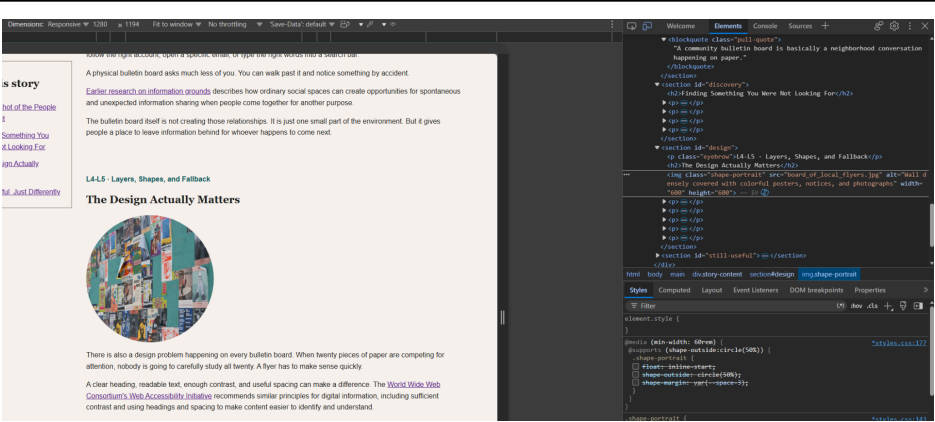
clip-path disabled - PASS

The clip-path declaration was disabled in DevTools. The photograph returned to its complete rectangular form and no essential content was lost.



shape-outside disabled - **PASS**

The shaped float declarations were disabled. The supporting image and article text returned to normal document flow and remained readable



Stacking-content inspection - **PASS**

Layered elements used the documented token scale. The pull quote used the raised layer, the sticky navigation used the sticky layer, and the issue badge required no explicit z-index.

Asset and Content Credits

Asset/Content	Asset/Source/Content Credit
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Melanie Weidmann. “A wall covered in posters and pictures of people.”
Unsplash. Used under the Unsplash License.

Source: [A wall covered in posters and pictures of people - Free Photo on Unsplash](#)



Umanoide. “Bulletin board covered in flyers with a bench.” Unsplash. Used under the Unsplash License.

Source: [Bulletin board covered in flyers with a bench - Free Photo on Unsplash](#)

Link: [Social spaces, casual interactions, meaningful exchanges: 'information ground' characteristics based on the college student experience.](#)

Fisher, Karen E., Carol F. Landry, and Charles Naumer. “Social Spaces, Casual Interactions, Meaningful Exchanges: ‘Information Ground’ Characteristics Based on the College Student Experience.” Information Research, 2007.

Link: [Information grounds and everyday life - Fisher - 2005 - Proceedings of the American Society for Information Science and Technology - Wiley Online Library](#)

Fisher, Karen E., et al. “Information Grounds and Everyday Life.” Proceedings of the American Society for Information Science and Technology, 2005.

Link: [Information grounds and everyday life - Fisher - 2005 - Proceedings of the American Society for Information Science and Technology - Wiley Online Library](#)

Research on information grounds and everyday information sharing, ASIS&T.

Link: [Designing for Web Accessibility – Tips for Getting Started | Web Accessibility Initiative \(WAI\) | W3C](#)

World Wide Web Consortium, Web Accessibility Initiative. “Designing for Web Accessibility.”

Link: [Policies | Tempe Public Library](#)

Tempe Public Library. "Display of Printed Materials Policy."